

Adriahna Blackburn

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Education

Bachelor of Science in Microbiology/Cell & Molecular Biology

May 2026

Oklahoma State University (OSU) | Stillwater, OK | Honors College

GPA: 3.99

Work/Research Experience

Fleming Scholar

June 2025-July 2025

Oklahoma Medical Research Foundation | Oklahoma City, OK

- 1 of 14 scholars chosen for an 8-week biomedical research internship.
- Investigated how chromosome “stretching” is related to chromosome segregation errors in meiosis.
- Improved microscopy measuring criteria of yeast chromosomes.
- utilized epi-fluorescent microscopy techniques, yeast plasmid transformation, and data analysis.
- Improved scientific communication by presenting work to a layman audience via an oral presentation.

Undergraduate Researcher

May 2023-May 2025

Oklahoma State University Department of Microbiology & Molecular Genetics | Stillwater, OK

- Elucidated the molecular production pathway of bactericidal molecules seen in the bacterium *Pseudomonas Aeruginosa*
- Improved scientific communication for a broad audience and was selected as 1 of 4 national Beckman Scholars to give an oral presentation at the annual Beckman Symposium.
- Mastered molecular cloning techniques, DNA/RNA extractions, PCR, procedure optimization, and critical thinking.

Peer Tutor

August 2023-December 2023

Oklahoma State University | Stillwater, OK

- Guided tutoring sessions for Introduction to Biology, Introduction to Microbiology, and Inorganic Chemistry I.
- Engaged others in active learning and bridged the gap between not knowing and understanding.
- Developed communication skills and learned how to cater knowledge to a wide array of students.

Extra Curriculars

Project Co-Leader

May 2024-May 2025

OSU International Genetically Engineered Machine (iGEM) | Stillwater, OK

- Developed and led a synthetic biology project to present at the international competition in Paris, France.
- Researched applications of photodynamic therapy, bacteriophages, and reactive oxygen species to treat *Staphylococcus aureus* skin infections.
- Taught other club members molecular cloning and basic microbiology laboratory techniques.
- Led outreach efforts at local middle schools by running science experiments such as DNA extractions.

President

May 2024-May 2025

OSU Society of Asian Scientists and Engineers (SASE) | Stillwater, OK

- Prepared Asian heritage scientists and engineers to be successful in the business world and in their careers by organizing professional workshops, company presentations, attendance at the SASE National Conference, social events, volunteering, and cultural celebrations.
- Oversaw E-board activities and responsibilities and acted as a point of accountability.

Member

May 2023-May 2025

OSU College of Arts and Sciences Research Leaders | Stillwater, OK

- Planned and executed workshops to help other undergraduate students navigate research experiences at OSU.
- Conducted classroom and club visits to provide information about my experiences in undergraduate research and information about the Beckman Scholars Program.

Honors and Awards

Goldwater Scholar

Spring 2025

Beckman Scholar- 1 of 2 inaugurating Beckman Scholars at OSU

Spring 2023-Fall 2024

American Society of Microbiology Missouri Valley Branch - Best Undergraduate Poster Presentation, 1st

Spring 2024

OSU College of Arts and Sciences Community Service Leader Award

Spring 2023